

FINLAND 2011

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1. Overview of the tax-benefit system

There exists a three-tier system of unemployment benefits: a basic benefit, earnings related benefit and a means-tested benefit. The earnings related supplement is paid to insured people only; insurance is voluntary. Housing costs are covered through a separate income tested scheme. There is a social assistance scheme which guarantees a minimum income for every inhabitant of the country. The tax unit is the individual.

1.1. Average worker wage (AW)

The 2011 AW earnings level is EUR 39 936¹.

¹ AW refers to the Average Wage estimated by the Centre for Tax Policy and Administration (www.oecd.org/ctp). For more information on methodology see *Taxing Wages 2007-2008*, OECD, 2009, part 5, sections 2 and 3.

2. Unemployment insurance

The basic benefit and the earnings related benefit are for the purposes of this study classified as unemployment insurance. The follow-up benefit (Labour Market Subsidy, note: only a change of English translation of benefit name, now according official to translation used e.g. by Social Insurance Institution) is classified as unemployment assistance. The basic benefit is funded by the state and employees (share of employees' unemployment insurance contribution paid employees that are not members of unemployment funds). The earnings related scheme is funded by the state, employers, and employees.

2.1 Conditions for receipt

Payable to any registered unemployed person, who is between 17 and 64 years old, who is available for and actively seeking full-time work. Persons receiving partial disability pension are entitled to unemployment benefits even if they are only seeking part-time work (no change in legislation just addition to description). Since 2005 also employees aged 65 to 67 are entitled to allowance during lay-offs (only employees, not for entrepreneurs).

Before 2009 Employment Committees that operated within the employment offices decided on a job applicant's right to an unemployment benefit in certain cases. Since 2009 Employment and Economic Development Offices (former employment offices) decide right to an unemployment benefit in all cases. If the unemployed person, without a justifiable reason, refuses to take on work, which is designated by the employment office and lasts for a maximum of 5 days, this results in a 30 day waiting period. If an unemployed person refuses to take on work lasting for more than 5 days or declines to enter training that is appropriate for him/her², or if the unemployed person is personally responsible for the fact that no employment agreement is made or if an unemployed person has been in the labour market for less than 6 weeks during the past 6 months without an acceptable reason, the result is a 60-day waiting period.

Unemployed persons bear the obligation of preparing for themselves, together with the employment authorities, a personal job-seeking plan. Työnhakijalla, joka jättää saapumatta suunnitelman laatimistilaisuuteen, ei ole oikeutta työttömyysetuuteen 15 päivän ajalta. If the job applicant refuses to take part in preparing a job-seeking plan, he/she will incur a 60-day waiting period. If the person do not attend appointed meeting for drafting job-seeking plan this will result in a 15-day waiting period. After a job-seeking plan has been prepared, refusal to carry out the job-seeking plan also results in a 60-day waiting period.

If the unemployed person resigns from a job without an acceptable reason or is personally responsible for causing termination of the employment contract, this results in a 90-day waiting period. Repeated refusal to take on work or training and reluctance to work can cause a cessation of allowance payments. In such a case, an unemployment allowance is not granted until after three months of work or training.

2.1.1 Employment conditions

34 weeks of work (minimum of 18 hours per week) in the last 28 (since 2003, still 24 months in the qualification condition for re-entry, see "return condition" below 2.4.) months. Wage must be according the collective bargaining agreement or if there is no such agreement for the sector, the salary for full-time employment must be at least 1052 euros a month (2010) Note: Current salary limit was

² Or has resigned or has been discharged from this kind of training (no change just addition)

introduced 2007 and it is adjusted annually by index (80 % wages and 20 % prices). Before 2007 the corresponding limit was 40 times basic daily allowance.

2.1.2 *Contribution conditions*

Earnings-related benefit: The employment condition has to be fulfilled while being insured as a member of an unemployment fund. Membership of unemployment fund is voluntary.

2.2 *Calculation of benefit amount*

2.2.1 *Calculation of gross benefit*

Basic benefit: EUR 25.74/day (5 days /week).

Earnings related benefit: Basic benefit; plus 45 per cent of daily reference earnings (DRE) in excess of the basic benefit until EUR 125.71; plus 20 per cent of DRE in excess of EUR 125.71 ($125.71 = 105 * \text{basic benefit} / 21.5$);).

In these calculations, the daily reference earnings are calculated as follows:

M = gross earnings in the reference year / 12.5 (monthly earnings are calculated here to exclude additional holiday pay included in the APW, hence the division by 12.5 instead of 12; note that in practice the 43 week period needed to fulfil the employment condition is usually used as reference period, excluding additional holiday pay).

$D = M / 21.5$ (21.5 working days /month)

$DRE = D * 96.33$ per cent (the deduction is 60 % of sum of employees' pension insurance contribution (under 53 years old), unemployment insurance contribution and earned income contribution for health insurance. This is done in order to avoid "over compensation" since these contributions are paid from wage and salary income but they are not paid on benefit income. Since 2010 deduction has been even formally connected to the level of social insurance contributions. Previously the deduction was set annually by separate decision of the Ministry of Social Affairs and Health

The earnings related benefit is calculated from the basic benefit excluding the child supplement. The child supplement is then added to earnings related benefit.

Child supplement is paid if recipient has children who are under 18 years old. If both parents are unemployed, both receive the basic/earnings related allowance and both receive the child supplement. Child supplement is paid even if parents are divorced and recipient does not live with children ("recipients biological children"). In addition to this supplement is payable if recipient is married or cohabiting and the spouse has children e.g. from previous marriage ("recipients non-biological children").

Child supplement (total)	Rate (in EUR per day*)
1 child	4.88
2 children	7.16
3 or more children	9.23

* Monthly/yearly equivalents are obtained using 21.5 days per month, 12 months per year.

Note that if both parents are unemployed, both receive the basic/earnings related allowance and both receive the child supplement.

The earnings-related allowance can be a maximum of 90 per cent of the daily wage, but at least equal to the basic allowance plus any child increases (applies also to previous years, no change in rules, only addition to text).

2.2.2 *Income and earnings disregards*

If an unemployed person begins to work part-time (including irregular work with reduced working time and full-time employment for a period not exceeding two weeks), the person is entitled to receive a so called adjusted unemployment benefit. The employee may also be entitled to adjusted unemployment benefit for some other reasons (e.g. if employer changes employment from full-time to part-time). The working hours may not exceed 75 per cent of the working hours of full-time work. The unemployment benefit is reduced by 50 per cent of gross income. The maximum amount of combined adjusted benefit (including child supplement) and income from part-time work may not exceed 90 per cent of reference earnings (100 per cent for those receiving increased earnings related allowance or allowance including re-employment supplement, see 2.5 below). Since 2010 there is no maximum period for adjusted unemployment benefit (Previously/since 1.12.2003: Adjusted unemployment benefit can be paid for up to 36 months. Maximum provision is not applied to persons who are 59 years old or older before the 36 month maximum provision is reached (57 years if person has been born 1949 or before()). However, due to transitional provisions 36 month maximum provision was not applied since 1994

Temporary rules for persons working shortened work week with correspondingly reduced wage (less than 80 % of regular working time): If working time has been reduced at least one full day the person is entitled for full unemployment benefit during lay-off days. The rule is not applied to persons working reduced hours each day even if the reduced working time is less than 80 % of regular working-time. Temporary rule covers only workers and not unemployed people starting to work shortened work week. Rules will be applied to lay-off days between 4.1.2010 and 1.1.2012.

2.3 *Tax treatment of benefit*

Taxable, but of social security contributions only the Health Insurance contribution (for medical care) is levied on the benefits.

2.4 *Benefit duration*

Paid for at most 500 days (5 days /week; 100 weeks) after a 7-day waiting period (see also 2.5.2). If there are several separate spells of unemployment during 500 days period only one 7-day waiting period will be applied. NOTE: Combined maximum period of unemployment allowance and training allowance for unemployed persons is 565 days if training has started before 2010 (only addition, applies also to previous years). Since 2010 the combined maximum period has been 500 days.

Since 1.1.2010 return condition same as employment condition 34 weeks during the 28-month period (gradual phase-in). Previously: since 1.1.2003 34 weeks (before 1.1.2003 43 weeks) of work during the 24-month period (minimum 18 hours a week) fulfils the employment condition for starting a new 500 days earnings-related period, so called “return condition”.

The reference earnings are based on the most recent earnings fulfilling the employment conditions. However, the new earnings related benefit level must be at least 80 per cent of the previous benefit level if the employment condition is fulfilled before the 500 days maximum period is exhausted.

2.5 Treatment of particular groups

2.5.1 Young persons

None.

2.5.2 Older workers or workers with long careers

Additional days rule

An unemployment allowance can also be paid after the 500-day maximum period for older workers ("additional days rule"). As a part of an extensive pension reform the unemployment pension scheme will be gradually abolished. Therefore also "additional days rule" has been changed as from 1 January 2003; accordingly, the rules differ to persons born prior to 1950 and those born after that date (reflecting the age limits of transitional provision of unemployment pension).

Persons born prior to 1950: The old rule is observed for a person who reaches the age of 57 before the 500-day maximum period has accrued. In addition to the 500 days, the person receives an allowance up to the end of the month during which he/she reaches the age of 60. Thereafter the person can apply for an unemployment pension (not covered here).

Persons born in 1950-1954: A person born between 1950 and 1954 can be paid an allowance up to the end of the month when he/she reaches the age of 65 if the person has reached the age of 59 before the 500 days have accrued. In addition, it is required that the person has been in employment with pension entitlement for at least five years during the past 20 years.

Persons born in 1955 or thereafter: A person born in 1955 or thereafter can be paid an allowance up to the end of the month when he/she reaches the age of 65 if the person has reached the age of 60 before the 500 days have accrued. In addition, it is required that the person has been in employment with pension entitlement for at least five years during the past 20 years. Since 1.1.2005 persons receiving allowance after 500 days (i.e. receiving additional days) are entitled to choose old age pension at the age of 62 (pension reduced due to early retirement, pensions schemes not covered here). Those who have chosen old age pension are not entitled to unemployment benefits.

Before 2010 persons receiving unemployment benefit for additional days were entitled to somewhat higher replacement rate if

- if the claimant had been a member of an unemployment fund for five years
- the claimant had been in employment with pension entitlement for at least 20 years

In these cases the replacement rate in upper income bracket was 32.5 per cent (normally 20 per cent, compare 2.2.1)

The increased rate for additional days was abolished 1.1.2010 (note that simultaneously other changes were introduced that increased benefit rate in upper income brackets recipients of “ordinary” allowance, see 2.2.1).

Increased earnings-related allowance

The earnings-related allowance may be paid as an increased allowance in the following situations:

Situation 1. The job seeker has been employed for a total of at least three years before the entitlement to unemployment allowance began. In this case the earnings-related allowance may be paid as an increased allowance for a maximum of 20 days at the start of unemployment. If a person making his or her first application for earnings-related allowance is entitled to the increased earnings-related component on the basis of situation 3 (see below), the person will lose the right to the increased earnings-related component referred to in situation 1.

Situation 2. The person is taking part in a service promoting employment agreed with the Employment and Economic Development Office within the employment plan or comparable plan. The increased earnings-related allowance may be paid during participation in the service, however for no more than 200 days. If the person is taking part in two services with an interval of no more than seven calendar days, the increased earnings-related allowance may also be paid for the time between the services.

Situation 3. The employment relationship is terminated for economic or production-related reasons or the person terminates the employment relationship after being laid off for more than 200 consecutive days. The claimant has been employed for no less than 20 years before losing his or her job and has been a member of an unemployment fund for no less than five years. In this case the increased earnings-related allowance can be paid for a maximum of 100 days.

Amount of an increased earnings-related allowance

- The increased earnings-related allowance is 57.5 per cent (normally 45 per cent) of the difference between daily wages (DRE) and the basic allowance. If daily wages (DRE) exceeds upper income limit ($90 * \text{basic benefit} / 21.5$) the increased earnings-related allowance declines to 35 per cent (normally 20 per cent) for the part in excess. I.e. the difference in compensation formula are these two percentages (formula: see 2.2.1 above)
- The rule in determining a normal earnings-related unemployment allowance, which says that the earnings-related allowance can be a maximum of 90 per cent of daily wages, does not apply to an increased earnings-related allowance. The increased allowance can be a maximum of the full daily wage (DRE) but nevertheless equal to the basic allowance plus any child increases

The period of unemployment need not continue without interruption, but there may be periods of employment in between. If there are so many periods of employment that a new employment condition is fulfilled, the days entitling to an increased earnings-related allowance are paid from the unemployment allowance calculated on the basis of the new wage or salary income.

Recipients of basic allowance are entitled to increased allowance with similar conditions (excluding the unemployment fund membership). The increase is EUR 4.42 per day (5 days per week).

2.5.3 *Entrepreneurs*

Unemployment benefits are also payable to entrepreneurs fulfilling conditions for receipt (including conditions for discontinuation of business activity). As with employees entrepreneurs have to members of unemployment funds in order to be entitled to earnings related benefit. There are separate unemployment funds for entrepreneurs. The earnings related scheme for entrepreneurs is funded by the state and insured (entrepreneurs). Specific details of this scheme are not covered here.

2.5.4 *Other groups*

Most services promoting employment also entitle the participant to additional maintenance allowance, which is payable for training agreed with the Employment and Economic Development Office after 1 January 2010. The maintenance allowance is intended for compensating meal and travel expenses. NOTE: The maintenance allowance has been paid since early 1990's. Since 1.1.2010 the coverage of maintenance allowance was extended to several services and studies that previously were not covered.

The maintenance allowance is EUR 9 per day (2004-2009: EUR 8 per day), and the increased maintenance allowance EUR 18 per day. Recipient is entitled to receive increased maintenance allowance if recipient is taking part in services promoting employment outside the travel-to-work area or if recipient has accommodation costs due to participation in a service organised within travel-to-work area. The maintenance allowance is non-taxable income.

The maintenance allowance (EUR 9) and increased maintenance allowance (EUR 18) may be paid for the duration of the following services promoting employment:

- labour market training for adults
- self-motivated study
- work try-out at a workplace
- trainee work
- preparation for working life
- comparable integration measures for immigrants.

Recipients of unemployment assistance benefits (chapter 3) are also entitled to maintenance allowance under similar conditions.

It is possible to receive maintenance allowance and increased allowance simultaneously.

Transition assistance

Since 1.7.2005 unemployed persons whose employment contract had been terminated for production-related or economic reasons and who fulfilled other qualifying conditions were entitled to re-employment programme supplement. The name (now transition assistance) and conditions of benefit were revised during 2009. This was part of government's responses to economic crisis.

Since 1.1.2010 the conditions for transition assistance have been:

The transition assistance may be payable if the job seeker has drawn up an employment plan or comparable plan at the Employment and Economic Development Office. The drafting of the plan needs to be requested in person at the Employment and Economic Development Office. The request must be made within 30 days of the termination of employment, the date you received notice of your lay-off or the date your period of being laid off reached the 180-day requirement.

The transition assistance is payable during participation in a service promoting employment recorded in the employment plan or comparable plan. Such services include labour market training for adults, self-motivated study, work try-outs, trainee work, preparation for working life, integration measures, rehabilitative work, and work and training try-outs. If the person is taking part in two services with an interval of no more than seven calendar days, the earnings-related component for transition assistance may also be paid for the time between the services. If the agreement on self-motivated job-seeking was made within the employment programme prior to 1 January 2010, the earnings-related component for transition assistance is also payable for the duration of the job-seeking period up to 31 March 2010.

Requirements for eligibility for the earnings-related component for transition assistance:

- The job seeker has a valid employment plan or corresponding plan.
- The job seeker has been a member of an unemployment fund for at least 34 weeks, during which time he or she has satisfied the employment requirement under the Unemployment Security Act: 34 calendar weeks of employment during the past 28 months.
- Job seekers who do not qualify unemployment fund membership condition are entitled to transition assistance supplement for basic unemployment allowance (4.41. €/day, 5 days per week).

Amount and duration of (earnings-related component for) transition assistance:

- The earnings-related component for transition assistance is 65 per cent of the difference between daily wages and the basic component. If the monthly salary is more than 105 times the amount of daily allowance, the earnings-related component for the exceeding sum is 37.5 per cent (compare 2.2.1).
- The transition assistance is payable for a maximum of 200 days.
 - The transition assistance will not be paid if the applicant is receiving daily allowance for the additional days following the 500 days
 - is a full-time entrepreneur.

Recipients of basic allowance are entitled to transition allowance with similar conditions as recipients of earnings related allowance (excluding the unemployment fund membership). The increase is EUR 4.41 per day (5 days per week).

3. Unemployment assistance

Labour Market Subsidy (LMS) is aimed at promoting first time entrants and recipients' re-entry to the labour market.

3.1 Conditions for receipt

Payable to any registered unemployed person, who is between 17 and 64 years old, who is available for and actively seeking work. Since 2005 also persons aged 65 to 67 are entitled to allowance during lay-offs.

See 2.1. for conditions for unemployed job-seekers generally ("voluntary" job loss, refusal to take on work designated by the employment office etc.).

3.2 Calculation of benefit amount

3.2.1 Calculation of gross benefit

The maximum Labour Market Subsidy benefit is equal to the basic unemployment allowance (see Section 2.2.1; since 2002 the child supplements are the same as well).

3.2.2 Income and earnings disregards

The income test is suppressed:

- During the first 180 days for persons who have previously received the unemployment allowance for the maximum period allowed (500 days).
- For unemployment allowance recipients aged 55 or more, who at the time they became employed satisfied the employment condition (43 weeks of employment during preceding 28 (since 2003) months).
- During any period in which the recipient participates in measures supporting his/her integration into the labour market that have been arranged by an employment authority.

The income-test is applied to the combined monthly gross income of the recipient and the partner; the latter's income is excluded until EUR 660 per month. The disregarded amount equals EUR 1044 per month for a couples and lone-parents or EUR 311 per month for a single plus EUR 130 per month for each dependent child. The LMS benefit is reduced by 50 per cent of the gross income exceeding the disregard, e.g. child allowance, home care allowance, maintenance support and housing allowance are disregarded from the income test. For single person the LMS benefit is reduced by 75 per cent of the gross income exceeding the disregard.

Example of an unemployed person with spouse (earnings EUR 2 200/month after deducting for work related expenses) and two dependent children:

Spouse's income in income-test	$2\,200 - 660 = \text{EUR } 1\,540$ /month
Disregard	$1\,044 + 2 \times 130 = \text{EUR } 1\,304$ /month
Income exceeding disregard	$1\,540 - 1\,304 = \text{EUR } 236$ /month
Reduction of LMS	$50\% \times 236 = \text{EUR } 118$ /month = $\text{EUR } 118/21.5$ per day = $\text{EUR } 5.49$ /day

Example of for a single person with additional income EUR 558 / month (e.g. capital income):

Disregard	EUR 311 /month
Income exceeding disregard	$558 - 311 = \text{EUR } 247$ /month
Reduction of LMS	$75\% \times 247 = \text{EUR } 172.9$ /month = $\text{EUR } 172.9/21.5$ per day = $\text{EUR } 8.04$ /day

If a recipient of LMS begins to work part-time (including irregular work with reduced working time), the LMS recipient is also entitled to the adjusted LMS. The rules are same as in earnings related unemployment benefit (see section 2.2.2). Note that both the income-test of adjusted benefit due to earnings from part-time work and the usual income-test above are carried out. First the amount of LMS after usual income-test is calculated as in the above examples. Then, the calculated amount of LMS is reduced by earnings from part-time work according to rules of adjusted LMS. Earnings from part-time work are not included in the income-test.

3.3 Tax treatment of benefit

Taxable, but of social security contributions only the Health Insurance contributions (for medical care) are levied on the benefits.

3.4 Benefit duration

Unlimited. There is a five-day waiting period for all recipients of benefits. First-time entrants to the labour market must complete a 5-month waiting period (unless they have recently graduated from a vocationally oriented educational institute).

3.5 Treatment of particular groups

3.5.1 Young persons

Partial labour market subsidy: For first time entrants to the labour market who live with their parents the labour market is reduced. Since 1.7.2003 the reduction depend on income of parents. If parental income exceeds EUR 1781 per month, the labour market subsidy payable is reduced by 50% of the excess. However, partial labour market subsidy is at least 50 per cent of the amount that recipient would have received without any reduction due to parents income (e.g. at least 50 per cent of the amount that recipient would have received after adjustment for own income from part-time work). The EUR 1781 disregard is increased by EUR 106 per month for each dependent child that parents have (aged 0-17).

A person aged 17-24 may not decline a job or training offer or choose not to apply for vocational training.

3.5.2 *Older workers*

Means-testing for previous unemployment allowance recipients aged 55 or more has been suppressed (see section 3.2.2.).

3.5.3 *Increased labour market subsidy and maintenance allowance*

The recipient is entitled supplement if recipient is taking part in a service promoting employment. The service must be agreed with the Employment and Economic Development Office within the employment plan or comparable plan and the recipient has not received labour market subsidy for more than 500 days before the start of the service (180 days if recipient has received unemployment insurance benefit for maximum of 500 days before this). The supplement/increase is EUR 4.42 per day (5 days per week).

Additional maintenance allowance during services promoting employment: see 2.5.4

4. Social assistance

Social assistance allowance is a residual social benefit which acts as a final safety-net. Since 1.1.2008 there has been single nation-wide basic standard (basic amount, see below). Previously there were two municipality categories.

4.1 Conditions for receipt

It is paid conditional on passing a means test. The need for social assistance is estimated each time case by case. For a person or a family that applies for social assistance a calculation is made of their income and expenditure entitling to social assistance. Expenditure that gives entitlement to social assistance consists of a basic amount plus an additional amount to cover outgoings which are assessed separately. If this combined amount is higher than the family's net income, the difference is paid in the form of social assistance. The basic amount is designed to cover the costs of food, clothes, hygiene, transport, information (newspaper, telephone, TV licence) and minor, everyday health care costs. Housing costs that are considered as reasonable are covered by additional allowance (7 per cent deductible was abolished 1.9.2006). I.e. reasonable housing costs are covered fully by additional allowance. Other expenditure items that are covered by additional allowance are home insurance, home electricity, (applies also to previous years, only clarification) children's day care fees and larger health care costs (pharmaceuticals, fees of health centres, doctors or dentists, cost of spectacles).

Since 2006 expenses entitling to additional allowance are divided to "other basic expenses" (not covered by basic amount) and to expenses entitling to "supplementary social assistance" The "other basic expenses" include housing costs, home insurance, home electricity and larger health care costs. Expenses entitling to "supplementary social assistance" include e.g. children's day care fees. This division is mainly for funding of social assistance. The central government grant to municipalities is 50 per cent of the expenditure on basic expenses of social assistance (i.e. basic amount + "other basic expenses"). "Supplementary social assistance" is covered by general central government grants to municipalities for social and health care. These general grants are calculatory and are not based on actual expenditure of individual municipality.

Usually all income is included into the means test (see 4.2.2). Taxes are deducted from the gross income. Assets are also included into the means test. There is no asset threshold, but a small part of savings may be disregarded in order to enhance the self-sufficient living of families. Some assets are also excluded from the means test. These include housing if occupied by recipients, furniture, tools for work or studies, etc. The possibility to realise property/assets should also be considered in the means test.

In most cases household receiving social assistance have other income sources during reciprocity period and social assistance is paid to top-up other benefits. In November 2009 only 9.3 per cent had no other income. 39.6 per cent had received labour market subsidy and 69.0 per cent had received housing allowance.

4.2 Calculation of benefit amount

4.2.1 Calculation of gross benefit

Basic amounts:

Family size	Rate ((in EUR per month)	Per cent of single rate
Single/Lone parent	419.11	100
Couple (per person)	356.24	85
Allowance per child		
Child over 18*	305.95	73
Child 10-17	293.38	70
Child under 10	264.04	63

* Children aged 18 or over, living with their parents constitute their own household when social assistance is calculated (separate means test).

If there is more than one child (0 – 17) in families the rates will be reduced. The rate of the second child will be 5 percentage points lower (e.g. 70 → 65 per cent or 63 → 58 per cent of single rate) the rate of the third and subsequent child will be 10 percentage points lower (e.g. 70 → 60 or 63 → 53).

In addition to these basic amounts for “everyday living costs”, additional social assistance is granted to cover reasonable housing costs or other costs (such as health care, work-related expenses). See above.

The amount of social assistance may be reduced by 20 per cent if person refuses to accept a work offer or do not participate in training or certain other activating measures. Since 1.1.2011 the social assistance may also be reduced if 18-24 year old person without vocational education refuses to participate in education or drops out from education. If refusal is recurrent social assistance may be reduced by 40 per cent. If social assistance is reduced authorities must, if possible, in co-operation with the recipient, to devise a plan to enhance “self-sufficient living of the recipient”. For the purpose of this study, SA is calculated as the basic amount plus the rent (until 31.8.2006 the basic amount plus 93 per cent of the rent). That part of the rent that exceeds the upper limit for reasonable housing costs in social assistance is not covered (NOTE: Change in methodology). The municipalities can use their own discretion in setting the upper limit for reasonable housing costs in social assistance. Social assistance covers often higher housing costs than housing allowances (*i.e.* social assistance has higher maximum amount). In calculations (non-binding) guidelines used by the city of Helsinki have been used (see appendix 2, NOTE: Change in methodology from 2008 onwards). Guidelines are only general and in some cases even higher cost may be covered. Note that upper limits presented in appendix 2 apply only to rent. Reasonable utility charges (e.g. water), household electricity and home insurance will be covered separately. The limits of reasonable

housing costs covered by social assistance are generally higher in Helsinki and in other municipalities of capital area than in other parts of Finland. Using guidelines of Helsinki will thus give more generous picture of social assistance than using guidelines of some other municipality (cf. assumptions of housing allowance below).

To calculate the final SA benefit amount, the procedure is comparing the net income from all other sources to this level. If it is above it there is no right to social assistance. If it is below the level then the actual social assistance that is payable is the difference between the social assistance level and the net income from all other sources (including regular housing benefits).

Social assistance can be paid to supplement (top-up) other benefits and other income sources (e.g wage and salary). Most of the recipient households of social assistance have other income sources which social assistance “tops-up”. One typical top-up case is single long-term unemployed receiving labour market subsidy (net of taxes), housing allowance and social assistance

4.2.2 *Income and earnings disregards*

Social assistance: Since April 2005 is 20 per cent of net earnings up to the maximum amount EUR 150 (/month /family) will be excluded from the income-testing. The law will be in force until 31 December 2014. Otherwise no disregards: All earnings from paid work and all social/family benefits included in this chapter reduce the maximum benefit. Municipalities may disregard some earnings if they are considered to promote the independence of the recipient.

Following cash benefits are disregarded from income-testing:

Disability allowance

Child disability allowance

Pensioner’s care allowance

Maternity grant

Maintenance allowance paid during the labour market training, rehabilitation or rehabilitating work experience. Maintenance allowance is paid as a reimbursement for the extra meal, travel and accommodation expenses incurred in the training or rehabilitation.

4.3 *Tax treatment of benefit*

Not taxable.

4.4 *Benefit duration*

As long as the means-test is satisfied.

4.5 *Treatment of particular groups*

4.5.1 *Young persons*

See section 4.2.1.

4.5.2 *Older workers*

None.

5. **Housing benefits**

There are three income-tested schemes:

- A general housing allowance available to families, couples and single people of limited means.
- A housing allowance for pensioners (not considered).
- An allowance scheme for students (not considered).

5.1 ***Conditions for receipt***

Income-tested.

Eligibility for the housing allowance is reviewed once a year. Special eligibility reviews are conducted in the following events:

- the household's regular monthly income increases by €300 (€160 in 2002-2004) or decreases by €160 a month or more, or monthly housing costs change by €50 or more)
- the household moves
- the number of household members changes
- ownership of the dwelling changes
- a subtenant moves in or out
- a member of the household becomes eligible for the student's housing supplement or becomes ineligible for the general housing allowance
- a member of the household becomes eligible for the pensioners' housing allowance.
- The special review is conducted at the beginning of the month following a change in circumstances. The regular annual review will then be conducted one year after the special review.

Since 1.3.2006 the income test (income review) due to an increase in income has been suppressed for three months for re-employed persons who have been receiving labour market subsidy or basic unemployment allowance continuously for 12 months or more.

5.2 Calculation of benefit amount

5.2.1 Calculation of gross benefit

The housing benefit is limited to certain income bands that vary with the number of persons in the household and with the geographical location. The general housing allowance is 80 per cent of the difference between the rent and a so-called “deductible amount”. The deductible amount is determined by the family type and the geographical location and increases with small steps as gross income increases (there are several income brackets for each family type and area). The incomes are rounded to the nearest full euro before the income test. The 2011 deductible amounts for Helsinki (I municipality group since 2002) and Espoo, Kauniainen and Vantaa (together II municipality group since 2002) are presented in appendix 1.

In housing allowance only full euros of income are finally taken into account in the income-test. E.g. if total household income from all income sources included in the income-test is € 1065.79 then only € 1065 is taken into account in income-test.

There are upper limits for the rents (housing costs) that are covered by the housing costs. In some areas these limits may in practice be below the market rate.

The calculation of maximum housing costs is rather complicated. There is a maximum area of the dwelling for each household size:

Persons	Maximum area, m ²
1	37
2	57
3	77
4	90
5	105
6	115
7	125
8	135

Then there are limits for maximum housing costs per m². These limits depend on the municipality group, age and size of the dwelling and for some other criterion that are not important here. Below are the limits for the Helsinki (first municipality group since 2002).

Maximum housing costs per m2 in 2011, Helsinki (I municipality group)

Reference date for all information is **July 1st 2011**

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Size of dwelling, m2	Age of dwelling		
	-1985	1986-95	1996 -
-25,9	13.25	14.08	14.58
26-30,9	12.41	13.23	13.74
31-35,9	11.57	12.39	12.90
36-45,9	10.8	11.91	12.41
46-60,9	10.33	11.6	12.11
61-80,9	10.09	11.17	11.67
81-	10.01	11.08	11.59

Example: the assumption concerning housing costs is that they are 20 per cent of the AW for all family types. For Finland 2011 this is equivalent of housing cost of EUR xxx.xx per month (= 20% * xx xxx/ 12). For a single person living in a 35m² dwelling in Helsinki, in a house which was built in 2000, the maximum amount is 35 * 12.90 = EUR 451.50 , which is clearly below EUR xx xxx. Result: the costs above 451.50 are ignored when the housing allowance is calculated.

For the purpose of this study the table below is used to calculate the maximum housing cost:

Maximum housing cost per month

Number of persons in the household	Maximum housing cost
1	35*12.90
2	55* 12.11
3	75*11.67
4	85*11.59
5	100* 11.59
6	110* 11.59

Smallest amount payable: If the allowance after income test is less than EUR 16.81 per month allowance is not paid (no change in rules just addition to the description, the limit has been same since early 1990's, FIM 100 before 2002)..

5.2.2 *Income and earnings disregards*

There is a special EUR 90 per month disregard for lone parents with one child. If there are more than eight person in a household EUR 260 is deducted from the monthly gross income for each person above eight person (applies also to previous years, no change in rules, only addition to text). Earnings, unemployment benefits and home care allowance are taken into the income-test; child allowance and maintenance support are disregarded. 15 per cent of the assets above certain thresholds are considered as income. This amount is divided by 12 to get monthly income. The thresholds vary with family size.

5.3 *Tax treatment of benefit*

Not taxable.

5.4 *Treatment of particular groups*

Students and pensioners have special housing allowances.

5.5 *Eligibility review (addition; applies also to previous years)*

Eligibility for the housing allowance is reviewed once a year. Special eligibility reviews are conducted in the following events:

- the household's regular monthly income increases by €300 (€160 in 2002-2004) or decreases by €160 a month or more, or monthly housing costs change by €50 or more)
- the household moves
- the number of household members changes
- ownership of the dwelling changes
- a subtenant moves in or out
- a member of the household becomes eligible for the student's housing supplement or becomes ineligible for the general housing allowance
- a member of the household becomes eligible for the pensioners' housing allowance.
- The special review is conducted at the beginning of the month following a change in circumstances. The regular annual review will then be conducted one year after the special review.

Since 1.3.2006 the income test (income review) due to an increase in income has been suppressed for three months for re-employed persons who have been receiving labour market subsidy or basic unemployment allowance continuously for 12 months or more.

Reference date for all information is **July 1st 2011**

Country chapter for OECD series *Benefits and Wages* (www.oecd.org/els/social/workincentives)

6. Family benefits

6.1 *Conditions for receipt*

Child Benefit is paid for children under 17 who are living in Finland. Its amount depends on the number of eligible children in the household. Single parents get a supplement for each child

6.2 *Calculation of benefit amount*

6.2.1 *Calculation of gross benefit*

Rates of child benefit since 1.3.2011	
	Rate per child (in EUR per month)
1st child	100.40
2nd child	110.94
3rd child	141.56
4th child	162.15
5th and subsequent	182.73

Since 1.3.2011 rates will be adjusted annually by index (100 % prices). This will be normally carried out 1st of January.

6.2.2 *Income and earnings disregards*

Universal, not means-tested.

6.3 *Tax treatment of benefit*

Not taxable.

6.4 *Treatment of particular groups*

6.4.1 *Young persons*

6.4.2 *Older workers*

6.4.3 *Others if applicable*

Lone parents: Additional allowance of EUR 46.79 per child per month.

7. *Childcare for pre-school children*

Parents can choose to place their child in a day-care centre run by the municipality, look after the child themselves with the help of the child home care allowance, or choose the private day care allowance and arrange for child care privately. The parents of all children under official school age (7 years) have the right to a place in day care for their child provided by their local authority. Day care is provided as part-time and full-time care. Also day care around the clock is arranged when needed. Day care can also be organized for children of school age but mostly school-aged children participate in after-school activities. Public day care may be organized through day care centres or as municipal family day care

Child care arrangements vary considerably according to the age of the child. In 2009 24.1 per cent of all 0-2 year old children were in municipal day care. 66.2 per cent of all the 3-6 year old children were in municipal day care. Majority of children in day care use municipal day care (municipal day care centre or

municipal family day care). Almost all six-year-old children take part in pre-school education. 65 per cent of the pre-school aged children also attend day care.

Day care fees cover only a small part of the total costs of municipal day care (about 14% in year 2009).

7.1 *Out-of-pocket childcare fees paid by parents*

The fees and income limits were adjusted according to indexation rules 1.8.2010. The public day care fees are income related; the higher the family income, the higher the fee. The fee is a portion (percentage value) of the family income exceeding the income limit until the maximum amount is reached. These limits and percentages depend on family size. In addition to parents children under 18 are included in the family definition.

All the amounts in the following table are monthly:

The grounds for public day care fees

<i>Family size, persons</i>	<i>Income limit, in EUR per month</i>	<i>Per cent of income exceeding the limit</i>
2	1198	11.5
3	1477	9.4
4	1754	7.9
5	1871	7.9
6	1988	7.9

If the family size is over six persons EUR 117 is added to income limit for each additional person.

If there are more than two children in the same family in the public day care, the fees of the third and subsequent children are 20 per cent of the fee for the first child. The maximum fee for the first (the youngest) child is EUR 254 /child /month. For the second child the maximum fee is EUR 229 /child /month. If the day care fee of a child amounts to less than EUR 23 it is not paid.

Example (with rates applicable after 1.8.2010): A couple with three children all in day care. Gross income EUR 5000 /month. Family type is 5 => $(5000 - 1871) * 7.9 \% = 247.19$. Fee for the first child : $\min(247.19, 254) = 247.19$ €/month. Fee for the second child: $\min(247.19, 229) = 229$ €/month. Fee for third child: $20\% * 247.19 = 49.44$ €/month

If the child is in the day care for five hours or less per day then the day care is classified as part-time care and fees should be adjusted accordingly. There are no strict rules for this, but 60 percent of the fee for the full-time care is the current estimate of the average adjustment. The fee for the third and subsequent child are calculated in relation to the full-time equivalent fee of the first child even if the first child only uses part-time care.

Income definition in the income-test of the day care: All income (gross) except certain benefits and grants. Of the benefits that are disregarded child allowance, home care allowance, housing allowance and social assistance are relevant here. If family pays maintenance payment to other household this is deducted from the income. Note that both maintenance support and received maintenance payment are included in income.

7.2 *Child-care benefits*

7.2.1 *Conditions for receipt*

For families with children under three years old who do not use public day care, there is a home care allowance, which includes a care allowance and a care supplement. In addition to the home care allowance, there is private day care allowance for those who use private day care for children under 7 years old.. Since 1.4.2007 it has been possible for family to receive private day care allowance and home care allowance simultaneously (i.e. private day care allowance for a child in private care and home care allowance for another child not using public day care or private day care).

7.2.2 *Calculation of benefit amount*

The home care allowance is EUR 315.54 per month for the first child under three years old, EUR 94.47 per month for other children under three years old and EUR 60.70 per month for children between three and six years old (i.e. under school age). Home care supplement is income-tested. The maximum amount is EUR 168.86 per month and it is payable for only one child. These rates are applicable since 1.3.2011 and since 1.3.2011 rates are adjusted annually by index (100 % prices). This will be normally carried out 1st of January. The price indexation does not cover income limits.

When the family type is determined only children entitled to day care are included with maximum of two children (i.e. children under school age after the parenthood period of parents irrespective of their actual use of day care). The home care supplement decreases as the income exceeding income limit increases. There is no similar income disregard for additional children as with day care fees. Otherwise the definition of income is similar with day care fees with same benefits disregarded.

The home care allowance supplement

Family size (parents + children < 7, max 2)	Income limit (in EUR per month)	Reduction of care supplement, per cent of income exceeding income limit
2	1 160	11.5
3	1 430	9.4
4	1 700	7.9

The rates and rules of private day care allowance are somewhat different from home care allowance. The private day care allowance consists of a basic allowance and an income-tested supplement,

which both are paid for each eligible child. The basic allowance is EUR 160.64 /child /month and the supplement is at most EUR 135.09 /child /month. Note that unlike in home care allowance the supplement is paid for each child entitled to private day care allowance. The income criteria and limits of supplement are the same as those that apply to home care allowance care supplement. If the child attends a part-time pre-school arranged by the municipality one year before starting school, or if the child starts school one year early (at age 6), or if the child is within the extended compulsory education system and in his/her first year of school, the private day care allowance is paid at a rate of €59.11 per child/month, and the amount of the care supplement is halved from its normal rate. The private day care allowance is paid directly to service provider and is also taxed as the income of the service provider. The allowance is not paid if a relative or some other individual looks after the child without a formal employment contract or charges no fee for his/her services. However, if the child is under three years old, the parents can apply for child home care allowance. These rates are applicable since 1.3.2011 and since 1.3.2011 rates are adjusted annually by index (100 % prices). This will be normally carried out 1st of January.

Some municipalities, especially in the metropolitan area, pay additional supplements to home care and private day care allowances. The rates and eligibility rules vary. The rates of municipal Helsinki supplement for home care allowance in 2011 (since 1.3.2011):

264.00 €/month if there is a child under 1½ years old in family

218.64 €/month under 2 years old

134.55 €/month 2 years old (but under 3 years).

The supplement is paid for the family, i.e. only for one child.

7.2.3 *Income and earnings disregards*

In home care allowance and private day care allowance there are no similar income disregards for additional children as with day care fees. Otherwise the definition of income is similar with day care fees with same benefits disregarded.

7.3 *Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits*

Child home-care allowance is taxable income. The private day care allowance is taxed as the income of the provider of the day care services. If the recipient of home care allowance is not personally taking care of the child and the spouse receives unemployment benefit the home care allowance is deducted from the unemployment benefit. If the recipient of home care allowance is personally taking care of the child the allowance is not deducted from the spouses unemployment benefit.

7.4 *Benefit duration*

As long as the conditions are satisfied.

7.5 *Treatment of particular groups*

See 11 for partial care allowance.

The care of a disabled or chronically ill child can involve additional expense and often requires families to make special arrangements. To support care at home, eligible children who are aged 16 or less

and live in Finland are entitled to child disability allowance. The allowance is paid without regard to the parents' or the child's income or assets. It is free from tax and payable at three rates depending on the need of care and rehabilitation and the economic burden related to this. In 2011 the rates were EUR85.93, 200.51 and 388.80 month.

Special care allowance is payable to parents who take part in treatment or rehabilitation arranged for their child. Special care allowance is generally payable only for maximum of 60 days for per child in a calendar year.

8. Employment-conditional benefits

Low income earners in Finland are eligible for an earned income allowance. See section 10.1.2.

9. Lone-parent benefits

Lone parents receive an additional supplement to child benefit (see section 6). Also a child of lone-parent receives maintenance allowance when the person liable to pay maintenance payment neglects this duty. A child is entitled to maintenance allowance even when the paternity has not been confirmed. The maintenance support is EUR 142.86 /child /month in 2011. Since 1999 the rate has been the same also for remarried providers. There is no means-test. The maintenance support is not taxable.

2

10. Tax system

It consists of a central government tax, a local government tax and social security contributions.

10.1 Personal Income Tax Systems

10.1.1. Central government income taxes

Tax unit

Spouses are taxed separately for earned income.

Standard tax allowances

Standard tax allowances.

- **Work-related expenses:** a standard deduction for work-related expenses equal to the amount of wage or salary, with a maximum amount of EUR 620 is granted.

Rate schedule

Central government income tax.

Taxable income (EUR)	Tax on lower limit (EUR)	Tax on excess income in bracket (%)
15 600 – 23 200	8	6.5
23 200 – 37 800	502	17.5
37 800 – 68 200	3 057	21.5

68 200 and more	9 593	30.0
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Tax credit

An earned income tax credit is granted against the central government income tax. If the credit exceeds the amount of central government income tax, the excess credit is deductible from the municipal income tax and the health insurance contribution for medical care. The credit is calculated on the basis of taxpayers' income from work. The credit amounts to 5.9 per cent of income exceeding EUR 2 500, until it reaches its maximum of EUR 740. The amount of the credit is reduced by 1.2 per cent of the earned income (earned income = non-capital income including also pensions, daily allowances) minus work related expenses exceeding EUR 33 000. The credit is fully phased out when taxpayers' income is about EUR 95 000.

10.1.2. Local income tax

Tax base and tax rates

The tax base of the local income tax is taxable income as established for the income tax levied by central government.

Municipal tax is levied at flat rates. In 2011 the tax rate varies between 16.25 and 21.50 per cent, the average rate being approximately 19.17 per cent.

Municipal tax is not deductible against central government taxes. Work-related expenses and other non-standard deductions are deductible, as for purposes of the central government income tax.

Allowances in municipal income taxation

- An earned income allowance is calculated on the basis of taxpayer's income from work (income from work = wages and salaries and non-capital entrepreneurial income). The allowance amounts to 51 per cent of income between EUR 2 500 and EUR 7 230, and 28 per cent of the income exceeding EUR 7 230, until it reaches its maximum of EUR 3 570. The amount of the allowance is reduced by 4.5 per cent of the earned income minus work related expenses exceeding EUR 14 000 (earned income = non-capital income including also pensions, daily allowances).
- A basic allowance is granted on the basis of taxable income remaining after the other allowances have been subtracted. The maximum amount, EUR 2 200, is reduced by 20 per cent of the income exceeding EUR 2 200.

10.2. Compulsory Social Security Contributions to Schemes Operated within the Government Sector

10.2.1. Employees' contributions

Rate and ceiling

The financing of the National Health Insurance underwent a major change on 1 January 2006 with the splitting up of the scheme into two components: earned income insurance and medical care insurance.

The contribution base of the earned income contribution for health insurance (for daily allowance) is gross earnings. In 2011 the rate is 0.82 per cent of gross wage (different rules for entrepreneurial income). This contribution is deductible in taxation (cf. employees' pension insurance and unemployment insurance contributions below).

The tax base for the health insurance contribution for medical care insurance is net taxable income for municipal income tax purposes. In 2011, the rate of the health insurance contribution for medical care insurance is 1.19 per cent. There is additional 0.17 per cent contribution for those incomes that earned income contribution for health insurance is not payable (e.g. pensions, daily allowances). The income base for additional contribution is the difference between taxable income for municipal income tax purposes and earnings for earned income contribution for health insurance (i.e. gross wage here). If earnings for earned income contribution for health insurance are higher than taxable income for municipal income tax purposes then there is no additional contribution.

There are also an employees' pension insurance contribution and an employees' unemployment insurance contribution. Employees' pension insurance contribution which amounts to 4.70 per cent of gross salary for those who are under 53 years old (- 52) and 6 per cent for those who are 53 years old or more (53+). Employees' unemployment insurance contribution equals to 0.6 per cent of gross salary. These contributions are deductible for income tax purposes.

10.2.1. Employers' contributions

The average rate of the employers' social security contribution in 2011 is 22.5 per cent of gross wage.

11. Part-time work

11.1 Special benefit rules for part-time work

See section 2.2.2 (adjusted unemployment benefit).

Children younger than 3 give entitlement to partial Care Allowance if the parent is working less than 30 hours per week while looking after their child. The allowance amounts to EUR 90.00 per month (2010). The partial allowance is taxable income. Since 1.8.2004 also parents of first- and second-graders (usually 7-8 years old) are entitled to partial Care Allowance.

11.2 Special tax and social security contribution rules for part-time work

None.

12. Policy developments

12.1 *Policy changes introduced during the previous year*

Income limits of the labour market support (income-test) were increased in December 2010 (see 3.2.2).

12.2 *Policy changes announced³*

The new Government led by Prime Minister Jyrki Katainen was appointed on 22 June 2011. The new government programme includes improvements in several benefits. The basic unemployment daily allowance and labour market support for the unemployed will be increased by EUR 100 per month as of 1 January 2012. This will also increase earnings related unemployment benefits. The basic amount of social assistance will be increased by 6% as of 1 January 2012. In addition, EUR 5 million will be allocated towards increasing the social assistance provided to single parents. General housing allowance will be improved. The linear coordination of income and a total rent model will be adopted for housing allowance (will be introduced in 2013). The basic personal liability of housing allowance will be adjusted so that the increase in labour market support will not generally decrease housing allowance (as of 1 January 2012). There will be some additional improvements in housing allowance with the adaptation of total rent model in 2013. The government programme includes other less specific entries: In order to improve the incentives for moving into work, methods for improving the coordination of work income and social security will be sought, with the ultimate aim of increasing the employment rate. The implementation of the processing guarantee of unemployment security and income security will be ensured. The possibility of giving up means-testing in regard to the spouse's income in granting labour market support will be assessed.

3. The changes of benefit rules presented here may not have been ratified and their reading in Parliament may be unfinished or not even started.

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Appendix 1. Housing Allowances Deductibles

The 2011 deductible amounts of housing allowance for Helsinki (I municipality group) and Espoo, Kauniainen and Vantaa (together II municipality group)

Upper limit of the income bracket, EUR/month	Household size							
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8+
555	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
570	13	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
585	22	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
600	31	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
615	40	13	0	0	0	0	0	0
630	49	24	0	0	0	0	0	0
645	58	35	0	0	0	0	0	0
660	64	40	0	0	0	0	0	0
675	69	45	0	0	0	0	0	0
690	75	51	0	0	0	0	0	0
705	81	56	0	0	0	0	0	0
720	86	61	0	0	0	0	0	0
735	92	67	0	0	0	0	0	0
750	98	72	0	0	0	0	0	0
765	104	77	13	0	0	0	0	0
780	109	83	23	0	0	0	0	0
795	115	88	33	0	0	0	0	0
810	121	94	38	0	0	0	0	0
825	126	99	42	0	0	0	0	0
840	132	104	47	0	0	0	0	0
855	138	110	52	0	0	0	0	0
870	144	115	56	0	0	0	0	0
885	149	120	61	13	0	0	0	0
900	155	126	66	22	0	0	0	0
915	161	131	70	27	0	0	0	0
930	167	137	75	31	0	0	0	0
945	172	142	80	36	0	0	0	0
960	178	148	84	40	0	0	0	0
975	184	153	89	45	0	0	0	0
990	189	159	94	50	0	0	0	0
1005	195	164	98	54	0	0	0	0
1020	201	170	103	59	0	0	0	0
1035	207	176	108	63	0	0	0	0
1050	212	181	113	68	0	0	0	0
1065	218	187	117	72	13	0	0	0
1080	224	193	122	77	22	0	0	0
1095	229	198	127	81	26	0	0	0
1110	235	204	131	86	30	0	0	0
1125	241	210	136	91	35	0	0	0
1140	247	216	141	95	39	0	0	0
1155	252	221	145	100	43	0	0	0
1170	258	227	150	104	48	0	0	0
1185	264	233	155	109	52	0	0	0
1200	269	239	159	113	56	0	0	0
1215	275	244	164	118	61	0	0	0
1230	281	250	169	122	65	0	0	0

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1245	287	256	174	127	69	0	0	0
1260	292	262	179	132	74	0	0	0
1275	298	268	184	136	78	13	0	0
1290	304	273	189	141	82	24	0	0
1305	310	279	194	145	87	28	0	0
1320	316	285	200	150	91	32	0	0
1335	322	291	205	154	95	36	0	0
1350	328	297	210	160	100	41	0	0
1365	334	303	215	165	104	45	0	0
1380	340	309	220	170	108	49	0	0
1395	346	315	225	176	113	53	0	0
1410	352	321	231	181	117	57	0	0
1425	358	327	236	186	121	61	0	0
1440	364	333	242	192	126	66	0	0
1455	370	338	248	197	130	70	13	0
1470	376	345	253	202	134	74	21	0
1485	382	352	259	208	139	78	30	0
1500	388	358	265	213	143	82	34	0
1515	394	365	270	219	147	86	38	0
1530	400	372	276	224	152	91	42	0
1545	406	378	282	230	156	95	46	0
1560	412	385	288	235	161	99	50	0
1575	418	392	294	241	166	103	54	0
1590	424	399	299	246	171	107	58	13
1605	430	406	305	252	175	111	62	21
1620	436	413	311	257	180	116	66	25
1635	no HA	419	317	263	185	120	70	29
1650	no HA	426	323	269	190	124	74	33
1665	no HA	433	329	274	195	128	78	37
1680	no HA	440	335	280	200	132	82	41
1695	no HA	447	341	286	205	136	86	45
1710	no HA	454	347	292	210	140	90	48
1725	no HA	461	353	298	216	145	94	53
1740	no HA	468	359	304	221	149	98	57
1755	no HA	475	365	311	226	153	102	61
1770	no HA	482	371	317	231	157	106	65
1785	no HA	489	377	323	236	161	110	69
1800	no HA	496	383	330	241	165	114	73
1815	no HA	503	390	336	246	170	118	77
1830	no HA	510	396	343	252	174	122	80
1845	no HA	517	402	349	257	178	126	84
1860	no HA	524	408	356	263	183	130	88
1875	no HA	531	414	362	269	188	134	92
1890	no HA	538	421	369	275	193	138	96
1905	no HA	545	427	376	280	198	142	100
1920	no HA	552	433	382	286	202	146	104
1935	no HA	559	440	389	292	207	150	108
1950	no HA	566	446	396	298	212	154	112
1965	no HA	573	452	403	303	217	158	116
1980	no HA	580	459	410	309	222	162	119
1995	no HA	587	465	416	315	227	166	124
2010	no HA	594	472	423	321	232	170	128
2025	no HA	601	478	430	327	237	174	132

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2040	no HA	608	485	437	333	242	178	136
2055	no HA	615	491	444	339	247	182	140
2070	no HA	622	498	451	345	252	186	143
2085	no HA	629	504	458	351	257	191	147
2100	no HA	636	511	465	357	262	195	151
2115	no HA	643	517	472	363	268	199	154
2130	no HA	650	524	479	369	274	204	159
2145	no HA	657	531	487	375	279	208	163
2160	no HA	664	537	494	382	285	213	167
2175	no HA	no HA	544	501	388	291	217	171
2190	no HA	no HA	551	508	394	297	222	175
2205	no HA	no HA	558	516	400	303	226	179
2220	no HA	no HA	564	523	407	308	230	183
2235	no HA	no HA	571	530	413	314	235	187
2250	no HA	no HA	578	538	419	320	239	191
2265	no HA	no HA	585	545	425	326	244	194
2280	no HA	no HA	592	553	432	332	249	198
2295	no HA	no HA	599	560	438	338	253	203
2310	no HA	no HA	605	568	445	344	259	207
2325	no HA	no HA	612	575	451	350	264	212
2340	no HA	no HA	619	583	457	356	270	217
2355	no HA	no HA	626	590	464	362	276	221
2370	no HA	no HA	633	598	470	369	282	226
2385	no HA	no HA	640	606	477	375	287	230
2400	no HA	no HA	647	613	483	381	293	234
2415	no HA	no HA	654	621	490	387	299	239
2430	no HA	no HA	661	629	497	393	305	244
2445	no HA	no HA	668	637	503	400	311	249
2460	no HA	no HA	675	644	510	406	317	254
2475	no HA	no HA	682	652	517	412	323	258
2490	no HA	no HA	689	660	523	418	329	263
2505	no HA	no HA	696	668	530	425	335	268
2520	no HA	no HA	703	676	537	431	341	273
2535	no HA	no HA	710	684	543	438	347	276
2550	no HA	no HA	717	692	550	444	353	282
2565	no HA	no HA	724	700	557	451	359	288
2580	no HA	no HA	731	708	564	457	365	294
2595	no HA	no HA	738	716	571	464	372	300
2610	no HA	no HA	745	724	578	470	378	306
2625	no HA	no HA	752	732	585	477	384	312
2640	no HA	no HA	759	740	591	483	390	318
2655	no HA	no HA	766	748	598	490	397	324
2670	no HA	no HA	773	756	605	496	403	328
2685	no HA	no HA	780	764	612	503	409	335
2700	no HA	no HA	787	772	619	510	416	342
2715	no HA	no HA	794	780	626	517	422	348
2730	no HA	no HA	801	788	634	523	429	354
2745	no HA	no HA	808	796	641	530	435	360
2760	no HA	no HA	815	804	648	537	442	366
2775	no HA	no HA	822	812	655	544	448	372
2790	no HA	no HA	829	820	662	551	455	379
2805	no HA	no HA	836	828	669	557	461	385
2820	no HA	no HA	843	836	676	564	468	390

Reference date for all information is **July 1st 2011**

Country chapter for OECD series *Benefits and Wages* (www.oecd.org/els/social/workincentives)

2835	no HA	no HA	850	844	684	571	474	397
2850	no HA	no HA	857	852	691	578	481	404
2865	no HA	no HA	864	860	698	585	488	410
2880	no HA	no HA	871	868	706	592	495	416
2895	no HA	no HA	no HA	876	713	599	501	423
2910	no HA	no HA	no HA	884	720	606	508	429
2925	no HA	no HA	no HA	892	728	613	515	435
2940	no HA	no HA	no HA	900	735	621	522	442
2955	no HA	no HA	no HA	908	743	628	529	447
2970	no HA	no HA	no HA	916	750	635	535	454
2985	no HA	no HA	no HA	924	758	642	542	462
3000	no HA	no HA	no HA	932	765	649	549	468
3015	no HA	no HA	no HA	940	773	656	556	475
3030	no HA	no HA	no HA	948	780	664	563	481
3045	no HA	no HA	no HA	956	788	671	570	488
3060	no HA	no HA	no HA	964	795	678	577	495
3075	no HA	no HA	no HA	972	803	686	584	501
3090	no HA	no HA	no HA	980	811	693	592	507
3105	no HA	no HA	no HA	988	818	700	599	514
3120	no HA	no HA	no HA	996	826	708	606	522
3135	no HA	no HA	no HA	1004	834	715	613	528
3150	no HA	no HA	no HA	1012	842	723	620	535
3165	no HA	no HA	no HA	1020	850	730	627	542
3180	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	858	738	635	549
3195	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	866	745	642	556
3210	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	874	753	649	563
3225	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	882	760	657	568
3240	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	890	768	664	576
3255	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	898	776	672	584
3270	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	906	783	679	591
3285	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	914	791	686	598
3300	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	922	799	694	605
3315	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	930	807	701	612
3330	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	938	814	709	619
3345	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	946	822	717	627

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Country chapter for OECD series *Benefits and Wages* (www.oecd.org/els/social/workincentives)

3360	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	954	830	724	634
3375	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	962	838	732	640
3390	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	970	846	739	648
3405	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	978	854	747	656
3420	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	986	862	755	663
3435	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	994	870	763	670
3450	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1002	878	770	678
3465	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1010	886	778	685
3480	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1018	894	786	693
3495	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1026	902	794	700
3510	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1034	910	802	706
3525	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1042	918	810	715
3540	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1050	926	818	723
3555	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1058	934	826	730
3570	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1066	942	834	738
3585	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1074	950	842	745
3600	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1082	958	850	753
3615	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1090	966	858	761
3630	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1098	974	866	768
3645	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1106	982	874	774
3660	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1114	990	882	783
3675	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1122	998	890	792
3690	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1130	1006	899	799
3705	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1138	1014	907	807
3720	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1146	1022	915	815
3735	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1154	1030	923	823
3750	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1162	1038	932	831
3765	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1170	1046	940	839
3780	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1178	1054	948	845
3795	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1186	1062	957	854
3810	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1194	1070	965	863
3825	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1078	974	871
3840	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1086	982	879

Reference date for all information is **July 1st 2011**

Country chapter for OECD series *Benefits and Wages* (www.oecd.org/els/social/workincentives)

	3855	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1094	990	887
	3870	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1102	998	895
	3885	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1110	1006	903
	3900	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1118	1014	912
	3915	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1126	1022	920
	3930	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1134	1030	927
	3945	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1142	1038	936
	3960	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1150	1046	945
	3975	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1158	1054	953
	3990	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1166	1062	961
	4005	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1174	1070	970
	4020	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1182	1078	978
	4035	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1190	1086	986
	4050	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1198	1094	995
	4065	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1206	1102	1003
	4080	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1214	1110	1012
	4095	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1222	1118	1020
	4110	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1230	1126	1029
	4125	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1238	1134	1038
	4140	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1246	1142	1046
	4155	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1254	1150	1055
	4170	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1262	1158	1064
	4185	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1270	1166	1073
	4200	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1278	1174	1082
	4215	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1286	1182	1091
	4230	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1294	1190	1100
	4245	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1302	1198	1109
	4260	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1310	1206	1118
	4275	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1214	1127
	4290	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1222	1136
	4305	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1230	1145
	4320	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1238	1154
	4335	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1246	1163

Reference date for all information is **July 1st 2011**

Country chapter for OECD series *Benefits and Wages* (www.oecd.org/els/social/workincentives)

	4 350	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1254	1172
	4 365	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1262	1181
	4 380	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1270	1190
	4 395	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1278	1199
	4 410	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1286	1208
	4 425	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 294	1 217
	4 440	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 302	1 226
	4 455	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 310	1 235
	4 470	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 318	1 244
	4 485	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 326	1 253
	4 500	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 334	1 262
	4 515	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 342	1 271
	4 530	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 350	1 280
	4 545	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 358	1 289
	4 560	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 366	1 298
	4 575	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 374	1 307
	4 590	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 382	1 316
	4 605	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 390	1 325
	4 620	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 398	1 334
	4 635	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 406	1 343
	4 650	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 414	1 352
	4 665	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 422	1 361
	4 680	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 370
	4 695	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 379
	4 710	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 388
	4 725	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 397
	4 740	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 406
	4 755	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 415
	4 770	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 424
	4 785	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 433
	4 800	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 442
	4 815	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 451
	4 830	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 460

Reference date for all information is **July 1st 2011**

Country chapter for OECD series *Benefits and Wages* (www.oecd.org/els/social/workincentives)

4 845	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 469
4 860	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 478
4 875	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 487
4 890	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 496
4 905	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 505
4 920	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 514
4 935	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 523
4 950	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 532
4 965	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	no HA	1 541

Reference date for all information is **July 1st 2011**

Country chapter for OECD series *Benefits and Wages* (www.oecd.org/els/social/workincentives)

Appendix 2. Reasonable rent covered by social assistance in Helsinki, internal non-binding guidelines, 1997-2011

Rent , EUR* / month															
Perso ns in house hold	1997	1998	1999	2000	2001	2002	2003	2004	2005	2006	2007	2008	2009	2010	2011
1	381	381	381	437	490	490	520	520	520	520	520	560	560	600	620
2	553	553	553	589	600	600	600	600	600	600	600	665	665	700	740
3	673	673	673	706	710	710	710	710	710	710	710	800	800	810	850
4	757	757	757	774	820	820	820	820	820	820	820	910	910	920	1010
5	883	883	883	900	900	900	900	900	900	900	900	1100	1100	1100	1200
6	967	967	967	984	990	990	990	990	990	990	990	1200	1200	1200	1320
7	1051	1051	1051	1068	1100	1100	1100	1100	1100	1100	1100	1300	1300	1300	1430
8	1135	1135	1135	1152	1200	1200	1200	1200	1200	1200	1200	1400	1400	1400	1540

In addition to these amounts reasonable utility charges (e.g. water), household electricity and home insurance will be covered separately

Before 2002 euro=5.94573 FIM